

Econ/Civics

U.S.





About the Course

This course covers a variety of citizenship topics. Students spend the first term learning the art of asking questions as a means of relationship building. The second term focuses on government as students explore the historical documents and decisions from this rotation. The year finishes with a term of economics where students learn a variety of economic theories.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Citizenship: Grade 11 (U.S.)



Placement & Combining Tips

Lessons are occasionally integrated with composition lessons. Government lessons in Term 2 are shared with Grades 9-10, and the economics lessons finish the book begun in Term 3 of Grade 10.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
11	Econ/Civics: Grade 11 (U.S.) 1 time/week 40 min	What Would Keynes Do? The Art of Asking Better Questions Reading PDF

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Citizenship: Grade 11 (U.S.)				
Econ/Civics: Grade 11 (U.S.) Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12	Current Events: Grades 9-12		Ethics: Part 5 Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12	



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Econ/Civics: Grade 11 (U.S.)



What Would Keynes Do?



The Art of Asking Better Questions



Reading PDF



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)
(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Related Course Quick Links

- ∞ [Community Read Alouds](#)
- ∞ [Setting Up a Citizenship Notebook](#)

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or scan the QR
code for links.



Econ/Civics: Grade 11 (U.S.)

How To Approach



Prepare

If you, the student, are learning at home, work to schedule a time with your teacher when you can complete the lessons from *Ourselves* or your Ethics reading together, as these lessons are much richer when shared and discussed.



Recap

Connect back to the previous lesson. (Optional for Current Events).



Introduce

For news sources: Scan the headlines first to get an overview, and then choose a story to read.



Read

Read the selection assigned or the news story chosen for the time assigned. For rich, dense, or more challenging books such as *Ourselves*, it is a good idea to read them aloud. Keep an eye out for quotes to put in your commonplace book or events or characters to put down in your Book of Centuries.



Narrate

Process and integrate your reading by narrating either orally or in writing. Some lesson plans will give you a suggestion of how best to narrate. To keep yourself on track, you might want to set a timer so you stop reading with enough time to narrate.



Connect

After your narration, think about how what you read connects to other subjects, other books, other things you've read or watched, or seen in the past or present. For current events, look up where events occurred on a map and ask questions together to discern the quality of the piece. (e.g., Are there sources cited? Is there an obvious bias? If so, what do other authors have to say on this subject? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?) Consider reading an alternative perspective.



Citizenship Notebook

Record important ideas in your Citizenship Notebooks. Make a calendar of current events.



Teacher Note

These lessons are written directly to students, but to assist them throughout the year, please read through this section and the lesson plans so you are familiar with the instructions and flow of the lessons. You may also want to preview and choose which news sites to offer students.

Those educating at home might pick one lesson to read aloud (such as the Ethics readings on Cultural Engagement, Conscience, etc.) with their students to keep up the habit of oral narration and foster conversation and relationship and then simply give students these lesson plans and the rest of the books and check in with them throughout the term for conversation, support, and accountability.



It is valuable for those in a classroom setting to also have a mix of lessons, which students complete themselves silently, and others read aloud and narrated together. Classroom settings lend themselves well to additional discussion and sharing at the end of lessons, after everyone has narrated either together or independently in writing.

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Term 1

WEEK 1 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 11 (U.S.) - Lesson 1

Materials: The Art of Asking Better Questions, Journal or Notebook, Bible

→ READ

Intro-Ch.1, p.3-25

→ REFLECT

Think about the individuals that you interact with on a daily basis. Identify someone that asks good questions and ask that person what motivates him or her to ask good questions.

WEEK 2 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 11 (U.S.) - Lesson 2

Materials: The Art of Asking Better Questions, Journal or Notebook, Bible

→ READ

Ch. 2, p.26-39

→ REVIEW & LIST

Review the italicized questions throughout this chapter and list three questions in your journal or notebook that were intriguing to you. Explain why.

WEEK 3 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 11 (U.S.) - Lesson 3

Materials: The Art of Asking Better Questions, Journal or Notebook, Bible

→ READ

Ch. 3, p.40-57

→ LISTEN & TRACK

Divide a piece of paper into four squares. Write one of the four levels of questions in each square. One day this week, listen for the four levels of questions being asked by those around you and track how many times you hear the four levels of questions throughout the day.

WEEK 4 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 11 (U.S.) - Lesson 4

Materials: The Art of Asking Better Questions, Journal or Notebook, Bible

→ READ

Ch. 4, p.61-71

→ INTERVIEW

Identify one adult and one person your age to interview using David Brooks' questions listed on p.69. Give yourself plenty of time to interview each person. The goal is to get to know the person better, not simply to get through the questions.

WEEK 5 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 11 (U.S.) - Lesson 5

Materials: The Art of Asking Better Questions, Journal or Notebook, Bible

→ READ

Ch.5-6, p.72-92

After you read ch.5-6, Review Resource 4: Fascinating Facts About The Questions Jesus Asked on p.181-185.

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Term 1

→ WRITE

In your own words, list and explain the six reasons Jesus asked questions.

WEEK 6 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 11 (U.S.) - Lesson 6

Materials: The Art of Asking Better Questions, Journal or Notebook, Bible

→ READ

Ch.7, p.93-101

→ REFLECT & ASK

Reflect on the questions you have regarding God, the Bible, and faith. Ask the members of your family what questions they have regarding God, the Bible, and faith. Identify the questions that you have in common and as a family, take steps towards answering those questions.

WEEK 7 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 11 (U.S.) - Lesson 7

Materials: The Art of Asking Better Questions, Journal or Notebook, Bible

→ READ

Ch.8-9, p.105-123

→ INTERVIEW

Identify a person who is responsible for leading people and schedule a time to interview that person. Identify questions from Ch. 8-9 (especially from p.111 & 116) to ask during the interview. Reflect on your own leadership influence and ask yourself the questions on p. 111 & 116. If time permits, interview several leaders and compare their responses.

WEEK 8 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 11 (U.S.) - Lesson 8

Materials: The Art of Asking Better Questions, Journal or Notebook, Bible

→ READ

Ch.10, p.126-137

→ PLAN & IMPLEMENT

Designate a journal to be your Questions Journal. Reflect on the nine practices from Ch. 9 and organize the journal accordingly. Do not be tempted to rush this assignment. The more time you spend creating a Questions Journal, the greater likelihood you will see a transformation in how you ask questions.

WEEK 9 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 11 (U.S.) - Lesson 9

Materials: The Art of Asking Better Questions, Journal or Notebook, Bible

→ READ

Ch.11, p. 138-150

→ PRACTICE

Identify a family member or friend to participate in a question-asking exercise with you. On p.147, read #6 "Hold a questions-only conversation with others." Once you both understand the exercise, initiate the conversation and see how long the discussion lasts. Keep practicing until the exercise becomes more natural.

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Term 1

WEEK 10 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 11 (U.S.) - Lesson 10

Materials: The Art of Asking Better Questions, Journal or Notebook, Bible

→ READ

Ch.12-Conclusion, p.151-160

→ RECEIVE FEEDBACK

Identify two people that you interact with consistently and ask them to provide feedback on how you ask questions. Use the questions on p.152-153 to guide the conversation. The purpose of this exercise is to develop the skill of asking better questions. Do not be offended by the feedback you receive. Embrace the feedback and develop action steps that will help you further develop the ability to ask great questions.

WEEK 11 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 11 (U.S.) - Lesson 11

Materials: The Art of Asking Better Questions, Journal or Notebook, Bible

→ READ

Resource 2: Questions To Ask Ourselves, p.171-173

→ REFLECT & REVIEW

Review the Self-Reflection Questions on p.171-173. Which questions are the most difficult to answer? What changes do you want to make in light of these questions.

WEEK 12 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 11 (U.S.) - Lesson 12

Materials: The Art of Asking Better Questions

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

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Term 2	
WEEK 1	40m Econ/Civics: Grade 11 (U.S.) - Lesson 13
WEEK 2	40m Econ/Civics: Grade 11 (U.S.) - Lesson 14
WEEK 3	40m Econ/Civics: Grade 11 (U.S.) - Lesson 15
WEEK 4	40m Econ/Civics: Grade 11 (U.S.) - Lesson 16
WEEK 5	40m Econ/Civics: Grade 11 (U.S.) - Lesson 17
WEEK 6	40m Econ/Civics: Grade 11 (U.S.) - Lesson 18
WEEK 7	40m Econ/Civics: Grade 11 (U.S.) - Lesson 19
WEEK 8	40m Econ/Civics: Grade 11 (U.S.) - Lesson 20
WEEK 9	40m Econ/Civics: Grade 11 (U.S.) - Lesson 21
WEEK 10	40m Econ/Civics: Grade 11 (U.S.) - Lesson 22
WEEK 11	40m Econ/Civics: Grade 11 (U.S.) - Lesson 23
WEEK 12	40m Econ/Civics: Grade 11 (U.S.) - Lesson 24

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Term 3

WEEK 1 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 11 (U.S.) - Lesson 25

Materials: What Would Keynes Do?, link, and notebook

→ NOTE

Part 2 lessons cover Ch.5, sections of Ch.3, and Ch.4.

→INTRO

Skim back over the sections to remind yourself of the topics from Part 1; remember that you encountered several economists and their approaches/positions on the specific issue being covered. Focus on theory and positions rather than trying to memorize names.

• DEFINITIONS:

The marginal tax rate is the amount of additional tax paid for every additional dollar earned as income. The average tax rate is the total tax paid divided by the total income earned. If you want to know more, see the expanded definition from TaxEDU.

→ VIEW

∞ Link: Marginal Tax Rate (TaxEDU)

→ RECAP

Opportunity cost = the next best alternative you forgo (p.45)

Deadweight welfare = money spent is greater than utility gained, leading to an inefficient allocation of resources (p.71)

Income effect = higher wages mean we can gain our target income through working less and enjoying more leisure time (p.93)

→ READ

p.150-157

→ DISCUSS AND/OR WRITE

- "There is no such thing as a tax cut without an opportunity cost" (p.153). If discussing these lessons with someone is not an option, write down your thoughts about the quote.

TEACHER TIP:

Discussion of these lessons adds a lot to the study of economics.

• COMPOSITION

Write an essay on the economic positions of "sweatshops." Be sure to include your position and support your answer with the text and/or other sources.

WEEK 2 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 11 (U.S.) - Lesson 26

Materials: What Would Keynes Do?, notebook

• DEFINITIONS:

A subsidy is a direct or indirect payment by a government to help an industry or business, or to aid individuals and households. Economies of scale refer to the cost reduction when a company increases production, thus spreading the cost over a broader area.

→ READ

p.158-164

→ DISCUSS AND/OR WRITE

- Discuss Noma's "nuanced" approach toward government intervention in declining industries (p.158-159). Why does he support it?
- Describe Ricardo's theory of comparative advantage. Give an example.

WEEK 3 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 11 (U.S.) - Lesson 27

Materials: What Would Keynes Do?, notebook

• DEFINITIONS:

Critical mass is an amount large enough to produce a particular result.

• COMPOSITION - Letter

Write a letter to someone discussing the legalization of drugs. Using your Economics text (and other sources if you'd like),

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Term 3

→ **READ**
p.165-172

take a stance on the topic and support your position.

→ **DISCUSS AND/OR WRITE**
• What are the "social costs" of imposing parking charges?

WEEK 4 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 11 (U.S.) - Lesson 28

Materials: What Would Keynes Do?, notebook

• **DEFINITIONS:**
In economics, austerity refers to a government policy of reducing debt and curtailing spending. Think about liquidity as the ability to have cash quickly.

Marginal utility = the economics as a basis for maximization of personal satisfaction/happiness - maximize pleasure and minimize pain (p.19).

→ **READ**
p.173-179

→ **DISCUSS AND/OR WRITE**
• Is government debt positive, negative, or in between? Discuss the different economists' views on government debt.
• Contrast the perspectives of Sowell and Pigou on welfare programs.

WEEK 5 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 11 (U.S.) - Lesson 29

Materials: What Would Keynes Do?, notebook

→ **INTRO**
For your second reading and moving forward, you will jump back to Chapter 3, "Work," and Chapter 4, "Finance," to finish the Part 2 lessons.

→ **READ**
p.180-183; 86-90

→ **DISCUSS AND/OR WRITE**
• Discuss the positions of private and public healthcare options.
• Discuss the theory of human capital as it relates to educational choices.

WEEK 6 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 11 (U.S.) - Lesson 30

Materials: What Would Keynes Do?, notebook

→ **INTRO**
Lessons now jump back to Chapter 3, "Work," and Chapter 4, "Finance," to finish the Part 2 lessons.

→ **READ**
p.91-98

→ **DISCUSS AND/OR WRITE**
• Reflect on the idea of diminishing marginal utility and happiness economics. Where do you find true happiness?
• Discuss the economic theory "that places emphasis on financial incentives to motivate workers," along with the idea of non-financial incentives shown in Maslow's hierarchy of needs. (p.96-97).



Term 3

WEEK 7 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 11 (U.S.) - Lesson 31

Materials: What Would Keynes Do?, link, and notebook

• DEFINITIONS:

Libertarianism - a political philosophy that strongly values individual freedom and minimal government involvement

Welfare state - a concept of government in which the state plays a key role in the economic and social well-being of its citizens

→ RECAP

GDP = Gross Domestic Product, the national income of a country (p.78).

→ READ

p.99-102

→ DISCUSS AND/ OR WRITE

- Discuss the charts on p.101 as they relate to immigration and supply and demand for labor.

→ INTRO

Entrepreneurship is essential to the economy. Two twentieth-century economists, Joseph Schumpeter and Israel Kirzner, contribute more to the conversation. In Chapter 2, you read how Kirzner suggests that entrepreneurs (and consumers) find ways around problems (p.55), and Schumpeter talks about creative destruction (p.158) - more on that in the finance section. Innovation brings about change, and entrepreneurs are change agents.

In the non-profit sector, innovation is about supporting a mission-driven vision that provides a product or service to supply a need. Think about this in the context of social needs or religious ministry; the organizations that support these areas can be for-profit or non-profit. Non-profit organizations also have business structures. Since the lesson discusses the idea of being employed by a business vs. setting up your own business, now is a good time to take a quick look at what that might mean for an entrepreneur in the ministry sector. Let's take a look at basic finance for nonprofits by watching a short video as an introduction to accounting and business practices.

→ READ

p.104-107

→ DISCUSS AND/OR WRITE

- Discuss the idea of self-employment. Write a brief pro/con list for working for a company vs. being your own boss. What are the "trade-offs"?

→ VIEW

Watch the section on non-profit accounting. This is a short clip made for a specific software platform, but the fundamental ideas are all explained well.

∞ Video Link: What is Accounting? (Aplos)

WEEK 8 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 11 (U.S.) - Lesson 32

Materials: What Would Keynes Do?, notebook

→ READ

p.108-115



Term 3

→ DISCUSS AND/OR WRITE

- What are the different potential positive and negative outcomes from each approach to a pay raise?
- What type of boss would you like to have? What type of boss do you think it would make sense to be?

WEEK 9 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 11 (U.S.) - Lesson 33

Materials: What Would Keynes Do?, notebook

→ READ

p.116-119; p.122-125

→ DISCUSS AND/OR WRITE

- Can you think of more pros and cons to maximizing profit vs. focusing on something else as the primary goal?
- Based on the few views presented about how to beat the market, what would you choose to do? Why?

WEEK 10 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 11 (U.S.) - Lesson 34

Materials: What Would Keynes Do?, notebook

→ READ

p.126-135

→ DISCUSS AND/OR WRITE

- What are some factors to consider when threats of high inflation loom on the horizon?
- What are your thoughts about how to make a business more profitable?

WEEK 11 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 11 (U.S.) - Lesson 35

Materials: What Would Keynes Do?, notebook

→ READ

p.136-147

→ DISCUSS AND/OR WRITE

- What are your thoughts on saving? What are some things to consider when trying to avoid financial bubbles? Is any type of debt a good idea? Why or why not?

WEEK 12 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 11 (U.S.) - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
What Would Keynes Do?

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Examination

Term 1

- The Art of Asking Better Questions: Explain how curiosity aids in developing the skill of asking great questions.
- The Art of Asking Better Questions: If a friend asked you, "Why is it important to develop the skill of asking better questions?" how would you reply?

Term 3

- What Would Keynes Do?: Should the government help failing companies? Give support for and against.
OR
Discuss the income-leisure trade-off (income effect and substitution effect of higher pay). When might you choose to take a promotion? Why might you decline?
OR
Discuss the Lazear quote "Incentives are the essence of economics" in light of Maslow's progressive hierarchy of needs pyramid.